

Word family: **embarrass / embarrasses / embarrassed / embarrassing / embarrassment**

Base word: embarrass

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

* **embarrass** (v.) — 令尷尬；使難堪；令丟臉

* **embarrassed** (adj.) — 感到尷尬的；難為情的

* **embarrassing** (adj.) — 令人尷尬的；令人難堪的

* **embarrassment** (n.) — 尷尬；難堪；令人尷尬的人 / 事

* **embarrassingly** (adv.) — 尷尬地；令人難堪地

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **embarrass someone**

* **embarrass someone in front of others**

* **embarrass yourself**

* **feel embarrassed**

* **be embarrassed about**

* **be embarrassed by**

* **be embarrassed to do something**

* **embarrassing moment**

* **embarrassing mistake**

* **public embarrassment**

* **to someone's embarrassment**

* **much to someone's embarrassment**

* **save someone embarrassment**

* **cause embarrassment**

Meaning in this passage

> He also said he was sorry for **embarrassing me in front of the group**.

Here, **embarrassing me** means:

making me feel awkward, exposed, and humiliated in front of other people — 令我尷尬；令我難堪；當眾令我下不了台

Kevin had publicly accused the speaker of delaying the group even though the accusation was wrong. The fact that other group members heard it made the experience particularly embarrassing.

中文翻譯：

他還特別為了自己當着大家面前**令我難堪**而道歉。

So here:

embarrass someone = 令某人在其他人面前感到難為情、丟臉或不知如何自處

1. **embarrass someone — 令某人尷尬 / 難堪**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He apologised for **embarrassing me in front of the group**.

他為自己當着全組人的面**令我難堪**而道歉。

Practice 2

> I didn't mean to **embarrass you**.

我不是故意要**令你尷尬**。

Practice 3

> His comment **embarrassed her**.

他的評論令她感到很**難堪**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****embarrass someone = 令某人因受到注意、犯錯、被揭露或處境不自然而感到尷尬或難堪****

2. **embarrass someone in front of others — 當眾令某人難堪**

Highly relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> He **embarrassed me in front of everyone**.

他**當着所有人的面令我難堪**。

Practice 2

> Don't **embarrass** your teammate in front of the group.

不要**當眾令隊友難堪**。

MCQ-ready definition:

embarrass someone in front of others = 在其他人面前使某人感到丟臉、尷尬或被暴露

3. **embarrass yourself** — 令自己出醜 / 尷尬

Practice 1

> I completely **embarrassed myself** during the presentation.

我在簡報期間完全**出醜了**。

Practice 2

> He was afraid of **embarrassing himself** in front of the class.

他害怕在全班面前**出醜**。

MCQ-ready definition:

embarrass yourself = 因自己的行為或錯誤而令自己陷入尷尬處境

4. **embarrassed** (感到尷尬的) — 尷尬的；難為情的

Practice 1

> I felt **embarrassed** after everyone looked at me.

所有人都看着我時，我感到很**尷尬**。

Practice 2

> He looked genuinely **embarrassed** about what he had done.

他對自己的行為看起來真的很**難為情**。

MCQ-ready definition:

embarrassed = 因受到注意、犯錯或不自在的情況而感到尷尬或難為情的

5. **feel embarrassed — 感到尷尬**

Practice 1

> She **felt embarrassed** when her mistake was mentioned.

有人提到她的錯誤時，她感到很**尷尬**。

Practice 2

> There's no need to **feel embarrassed**.

不用覺得**難為情**。

MCQ-ready definition:

feel embarrassed = 產生不自在、難為情或丟臉的感覺

6. **be embarrassed about something — 對某事感到尷尬**

Practice 1

> He was **embarrassed about his mistake**.

他對自己的錯誤感到很**尷尬**。

Practice 2

> She felt **embarrassed about what she had said**.

她對自己說過的話感到**難為情**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be embarrassed about X = 因 X 而對自己或某個情況感到難為情

7. **be embarrassed by something — 被某事弄得尷尬**

Practice 1

> I was **embarrassed by the attention**.

大家的注意令我很**尷尬**。

Practice 2

> She was **embarrassed by his comment**.

他的評論令她感到很**難堪**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be embarrassed by X = X 是造成尷尬感的直接原因****

8. ****be embarrassed to do something — 覺得不好意思做某事****

Practice 1

> I was too **embarrassed to ask** for help.

我太**不好意思開口**求助。

Practice 2

> She was **embarrassed to admit** that she had forgotten his name.

她很**不好意思承認**自己忘了他的名字。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be embarrassed to do X = 因覺得難為情而不願意或猶豫去做 X****

9. ****embarrassing (令人尷尬的) — 令人尷尬的；難堪的****

Practice 1

> It was an **embarrassing situation**.

那是一個**令人尷尬的情況**。

Practice 2

> I made an **embarrassing mistake**.

我犯了一個**令人難為情的錯誤**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****embarrassing = 會令人感到尷尬、難為情或丟臉的****

10. ****embarrassing moment — 尷尬時刻****

Practice 1

> It was one of the most ****embarrassing moments**** of my life.

那是我人生其中一個最****尷尬的時刻****。

Practice 2

> We laughed about the ****embarrassing moment**** later.

後來我們笑着談起那個****尷尬時刻****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****embarrassing moment = 令人突然感到難為情或丟臉的一刻****

11. ****embarrassing mistake — 令人尷尬的錯誤****

Practice 1

> The report contained an ****embarrassing mistake****.

報告中有一個****令人難堪的錯誤****。

Practice 2

> He made an ****embarrassing mistake**** during the speech.

他在演講中犯了一個****尷尬的錯誤****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****embarrassing mistake = 會令犯錯者覺得丟臉或難為情的錯誤****

12. ****embarrassment (尷尬 ; 難堪) — 尷尬 ; 難為情****

Practice 1

> She laughed to hide her ****embarrassment****.

她用笑來掩飾自己的****尷尬****。

Practice 2

> I could see his ****embarrassment****.

我看得出他的****難為情****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****embarrassment = 因不自在、犯錯或被注視而產生的尷尬感****

13. ****to someone's embarrassment — 令某人尷尬的是.....****

Practice 1

> ****To his embarrassment****, everyone noticed the mistake.

****令他尷尬的是****，所有人都注意到那個錯誤。

Practice 2

> Much ****to my embarrassment****, I forgot her name.

****令我非常尷尬的是****，我忘了她的名字。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****to someone's embarrassment = 某件事發生並令某人感到尷尬****

14. ****much to someone's embarrassment — 令某人非常尷尬的是****

Practice 1

> ****Much to her embarrassment****, the whole class started laughing.

****令她非常尷尬的是****，全班都笑了起來。

Practice 2

> His old photo appeared on the screen, ****much to his embarrassment****.

他的舊照片出現在螢幕上，**令他十分尷尬**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****much to someone's embarrassment = 某件事令某人感到非常難為情****

15. ****cause embarrassment — 造成尷尬 / 令人難堪****

Practice 1

> The error caused considerable ****embarrassment****.

這個錯誤造成相當大的****尷尬****。

Practice 2

> He apologized for causing her ****embarrassment****.

他為****令她難堪****而道歉。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****cause embarrassment = 令某人或機構陷入尷尬、難堪的處境****

16. ****save someone embarrassment — 免某人尷尬 / 難堪****

Practice 1

> I told him privately to ****save him embarrassment****.

我私下告訴他，以免他****當眾難堪****。

Practice 2

> She quietly corrected the mistake and ****saved me some embarrassment****.

她悄悄改正錯誤，讓我****少了一場尷尬****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****save someone embarrassment = 避免令某人陷入尷尬或丟臉的情況****

17. **public embarrassment — 公開難堪；當眾出醜**

Practice 1

> The incident caused him considerable **public embarrassment**.

那件事令他**當眾十分難堪**。

Practice 2

> She wanted to avoid **public embarrassment**.

她想避免**公開出醜 / 難堪**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****public embarrassment = 在其他人或公眾面前發生的難堪情況****

18. **embarrassment (令人尷尬的人 / 事) — 令.....難堪的人或事**

A useful countable extension.

Practice 1

> The repeated errors became an **embarrassment to the company**.

接連的錯誤成為令公司**難堪的事情**。

Practice 2

> The scandal was a major **embarrassment** for the organization.

那宗醜聞成為機構的一大**尷尬 / 難堪事件**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****an embarrassment = 令某個人、團體或機構丟臉或難堪的人、事情或問題****

19. **an embarrassment to someone — 令某人 / 機構丟臉的事**

Practice 1

> The unfinished project became an **embarrassment to the department**.

未完成的項目成為令部門**難堪的事情**。

Practice 2

> The error was an **embarrassment to the team**.

那個錯誤令整個團隊**很丟臉**。

MCQ-ready definition:

an embarrassment to X = 令 X 的形象受損或感到丟臉的人或事

20. **embarrassment of riches — 好東西多得反而難以選擇**

A fixed idiom.

Practice 1

> With so many excellent candidates, we have an **embarrassment of riches**.

有這麼多優秀候選人，我們反而**選擇多得難以取捨**。

Practice 2

> The restaurant offers an **embarrassment of riches** on its dessert menu.

這間餐廳的甜品選擇**多得令人難以取捨**。

MCQ-ready definition:

an embarrassment of riches = 好選擇或有利資源太多，以致反而難以選擇

21. **embarrassingly — 尷尬地；令人難堪地**

Practice 1

> I was **embarrassingly late**.

我遲到得**很丟臉**。

Practice 2

> The answer was **embarrassingly simple**.

答案**簡單得令人尷尬**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****embarrassingly = 達到令人覺得尷尬、難堪或有點丟臉的程度****

22. ****embarrassingly low / small / simple — 低 / 少 / 簡單得令人尷尬****

A productive degree use.

Practice 1

> Attendance was ****embarrassingly low****.

出席率**低得令人尷尬**。

Practice 2

> My knowledge of the subject was ****embarrassingly limited****.

我對這個科目的知識**有限得令人難為情**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****embarrassingly + adjective = 某種程度差、少、簡單等得令人覺得難堪****

Important distinction 1: ****embarrassed vs embarrassing****

Essential ****ed / -ing**** distinction.

****embarrassed****

the person ****feels**** the emotion.

> I was embarrassed.

我感到尷尬。

****embarrassing****

the thing ****causes**** the emotion.

> It was embarrassing.

那件事令人尷尬。

So:

person's feeling → embarrassed

cause/situation → embarrassing

Important distinction 2: **embarrass vs humiliate**

embarrass

make someone feel awkward, self-conscious, or ashamed.

humiliate

much stronger: cause deep shame and loss of dignity, often deliberately or publicly.

In your passage, **embarrass** is exactly right. Kevin's behavior was hurtful and public, but **humiliate** would make the description substantially stronger.

Important distinction 3: **embarrassed vs ashamed**

embarrassed

often arises from awkwardness or unwanted attention.

ashamed

usually involves moral guilt or a strong sense that you did something wrong.

> embarrassed because everyone looked at me

> 因被人注視而尷尬

> ashamed because I lied

> 因說謊而羞愧

Important distinction 4: **embarrassed vs shy**

shy

a personality/tendency around social interaction.

embarrassed

a reaction to a particular awkward situation.

A confident person can still become embarrassed.

Important distinction 5: **embarrassed vs awkward**

embarrassed

describes a person's emotional state.

awkward

can describe:

- * a socially uncomfortable situation,
- * a person's uncomfortable manner.

> I felt embarrassed.

我感到尷尬。

> There was an awkward silence.

出現了一陣尷尬的沉默。

Important distinction 6: **embarrassed vs uncomfortable**

uncomfortable

very broad physical or emotional unease.

embarrassed

specifically self-conscious or ashamed because of social exposure.

All embarrassment is uncomfortable, but not all discomfort is embarrassment.

Important distinction 7: **embarrass** vs **upset**

In your passage:

embarrass

focuses on being exposed **in front of the group**.

upset

focuses on the broader emotional hurt afterward.

So Kevin:

* **embarrassed** the speaker publicly,

* which made the speaker **upset**.

Important distinction 8: **embarrass** vs **offend**

offend

insult or cause displeasure, often because something violates values or respect.

embarrass

make someone feel socially awkward or exposed.

A comment can offend someone without embarrassing them, or embarrass without offending.

Important distinction 9: **embarrass yourself** vs **make a mistake**

Making a mistake does not automatically mean embarrassing yourself.

You **embarrass yourself** when the mistake or behavior causes social self-consciousness or makes you feel foolish.

Important distinction 10: **embarrass someone in public** vs **criticise someone in public**

criticise publicly

describes the action.

embarrass someone publicly

describes its emotional/social effect.

In your passage, Kevin does both:

- * publicly criticises the speaker,
- * thereby embarrasses them.

Important distinction 11: **embarrassment countability**

Usually uncountable emotion:

> I felt embarrassment.

我感到尷尬。

Countable person/problem:

> The incident was an embarrassment.

那件事是一件令人難堪的事。

This is a useful lexical shift.

Important distinction 12: **an embarrassment to vs embarrassed by**

an embarrassment to X

X's reputation/image is damaged.

> The scandal was an embarrassment to the organization.

醜聞令機構丟臉。

X was embarrassed by Y

X personally felt embarrassed.

> The manager was embarrassed by the mistake.

經理因錯誤感到難堪。

Important distinction 13: ****embarrassment of riches****

This is almost the opposite of ordinary embarrassment.

It does ****not**** mean someone is ashamed of being rich.

It means:

**there are so many good options that choosing becomes difficult**

Learn it as a fixed idiom.

Important distinction 14: ****embarrassingly + adjective****

This often works as a degree intensifier:

> embarrassingly easy

> embarrassingly low

> embarrassingly obvious

It means:

**程度到了讓人覺得有點丟臉的地步**

Family-extension note

The ****embarrass**** family has one strong emotional core:

**make someone feel socially exposed, awkward, self-conscious, or ashamed**

It develops into:

1. **cause the emotion**

* embarrass someone

* embarrass yourself

2. **person experiencing it**

* embarrassed

3. **thing causing it**

* embarrassing

4. **emotion/state**

* embarrassment

5. **person/thing damaging reputation**

* an embarrassment to the team

6. **degree**

* embarrassingly low/simple

7. **fixed idiom**

* embarrassment of riches

For your passage, the most important element is **public social exposure**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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embarrass someone	令某人尷尬 / 難堪	cause social discomfort
embarrass someone publicly	當眾令某人難堪	public exposure
embarrass yourself	令自己出醜	self-caused embarrassment
embarrassed	感到尷尬的	person's feeling
feel embarrassed	感到難為情	emotion
embarrassed about X	對 X 感到尷尬	topic/source
embarrassed by X	被 X 弄得尷尬	cause
embarrassed to do X	不好意思做 X	reluctance
embarrassing	令人尷尬的	causes embarrassment
embarrassing moment	尷尬時刻	awkward event
embarrassing mistake	令人難堪的錯誤	awkward error
embarrassment	尷尬；難堪	emotional state

to someone's embarrassment	令某人尷尬的是	resulting emotion	
cause embarrassment	造成尷尬	create awkwardness	
save someone embarrassment	免某人難堪	prevent embarrassment	
public embarrassment	當眾難堪	public exposure	
an embarrassment	令人難堪的人 / 事	reputational problem	
an embarrassment to X	令 X 丟臉的事	reputation	
embarrassment of riches	好選擇多得難取捨	abundance idiom	
embarrassingly	尷尬地 / 令人難堪地	degree/manner	

For your original sentence

> He also said he was sorry for **embarrassing me in front of the group**, and that part mattered a lot to me.

Here:

embarrassing me = Kevin 的公開指責令我在其他組員面前被暴露、被誤解，因而感到非常難堪

The phrase **in front of the group** is crucial. If Kevin had quietly asked:

> “Did you upload your slides?”

the situation might have been annoying, but far less embarrassing.

Instead, he accused the speaker publicly, which created the social feeling of:

everyone is now looking at me and may think I failed the group

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他還特別為了自己**當着大家面令我難堪**而道歉。

For this passage, **「令我難堪」** is stronger and more accurate than plain **「令我尷尬」**, because the embarrassment came from an unfair public accusation rather than an innocent awkward moment.